

Tractor

Michael Luo

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- Trick-taking card game popular in Chinese communities
- Goes by many names: *tuo la ji* (拖拉机, literally “tractor”), *sheng ji* (升级, literally “upgrade”), *ba shi fen* (八十分, literally “eighty points”)

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Tractor

About

About

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This presentation

- Meant to be concise, understandable, and include lots of examples
- Originally produced for RSI 2026
- Motivated by lots of requests for teaching

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└ This presentation

First bullet: I won't go over things like the drawing order

Second bullet: I probably taught around 20 people how to play, and I've unfortunately had to say no to people wanting to learn, it'd be nice to have a youtube video

This presentation

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Conventions for experts

- Two decks, four players.
- No throw penalty.
- Kitty points multiplied by 2^n , where n is the size of the largest component of the last trick.
- Subsequent throw must beat all cards to win.
- A must be defended, but 5, 10, and K do not need to be.
- J variation. Hehe.

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- Conventions for experts

If you already know how to play, we use the following conventions.

Conventions for experts

- ♥ Two decks, four players.
- ♥ No throw penalty.
- ♥ Kitty points multiplied by 2^n , where n is the size of the largest component of the last trick.
- ♥ Subsequent throw must beat all cards to win.
- ♥ A must be defended, but 5, 10, and K do not need to be.
- ♥ J variation. Hehe.

High-level summary

- 2v2 card game; four players and two decks (incl. low joker LJ, high joker HJ)
- Teammates sit across from each other
- Teams start at rank 2; they advance through the ranks 2, 3, 4, 5, 6, 7, 8, 9, 10, J, Q, K, A, NT (no trump) in order
- Winning rounds moves you up ranks, how many ranks you go up depends on “how much you win”
- Whoever passes rank NT first wins the full game

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High-level summary

Distinction between high and low jokers. The red joker is high. Jane Street deck.

Usually full games are not played due to length; but during all-nighters, ARML bus, etc.

High-level summary

- 2v2 card game; four players and two decks (incl. low joker LJ, high joker HJ)
- Teammates sit across from each other
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- Winning rounds moves you up ranks, how many ranks you go up depends on “how much you win”
- Whoever passes rank NT first wins the full game

High-level summary

- In each of ♣, ♦, ♥, ♠: 5, 10, K worth 5, 10, 10 points, respectively
- Everyone gets 25 cards
- A *trick*: the “lead” plays something, the players proceed counterclockwise **matching format**. Whichever team plays the highest thing of that format wins all points played in that trick.
- Tricks proceed until everyone is out of cards
- Goal: maximize points scored by your team

2026-06-26

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High-level summary

So there are $(5 + 10 + 10) \cdot 2 \cdot 4 = 200$ points total

$54 \cdot 2 \neq 25 \cdot 4$, I'll explain the other 8 cards

what does “matching format” mean? i'll clarify! this is the most important tractor rule

High-level summary

- In each of ♠, ♣, ♥, ♦, ♠: 5, 10, K worth 5, 10, 10 points, respectively
- Everyone gets 25 cards
- A trick: the “lead” plays something, the players proceed counterclockwise **matching format**. Whichever team plays the highest thing of that format wins all points played in that trick.
- Tricks proceed until everyone is out of cards
- Goal: maximize points scored by your team

Example

Convention

Examples have **Obama** and **Biden** (the *Democrats*) play **Trump** and **Reagan** (the *Republicans*).

Here, **Obama** is lead.

- **Obama** plays A♣.
- **Trump** plays 4♣.
- **Biden** plays 10♣.
- **Reagan** plays A♣.

Obama wins the trick since his A♣ takes precedence over **Reagan**'s. The Democrats win 10 points from the 10♣.

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Example

i'll explain the card orders later

Example

Convention

Examples have **Obama** and **Biden** (the Democrats) play **Trump** and **Reagan** (the Republicans).

Here, **Obama** is lead.

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- **Reagan** plays A♣.

Obama wins the trick since his A♣ takes precedence over **Reagan**'s. The Democrats win 10 points from the 10♣.

The *host* or *landlord* has two advantages.

- They make the first play.
- After everyone draws 25 cards, the host picks up the 8 remaining cards (the “kitty”) and replaces it with their 8 worst ones.

The host's team the *defenders*, the other team is called the *attackers*.
Who's host?

- Next person counterclockwise on the winning team is new host
- Host for first round is decided through bidding

last two bullets:

corollary, defending team and attacking team switch iff attacking team wins

which i will explain later

The host or landlord has two advantages

- They make the first play.
- After everyone draws 25 cards, the host picks up the 8 remaining cards (the "kitty") and replaces it with their 8 worst ones.

The host's team the *defenders*, the other team is called the *attackers*.
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The trump suit

The *trump suit* is the **highest suit**. Suits that are not the trump suit are called **offsuits**.

Plays matching shape in the trump suit beat corresponding plays in offsuits (“trumping”).

The trump suit consists of:

- Every joker
- Every card in the trump rank
- Every card in either ♣, ♦, ♥, ♠, depending on bidding

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└ The trump suit

third bullet: again, i will explain bidding later
for example, if the trump rank is 6, every 6 is a trump card. the trump rank is the current rank of the host team. so the trump rank always starts at 2.

The trump suit

The *trump suit* is the **highest suit**. Suits that are not the trump suit are called **offsuits**.

Plays matching shape in the trump suit beat corresponding plays in offsuits (“trumping”).

The trump suit consists of:

- Every joker
- Every card in the trump rank
- Every card in either ♣, ♦, ♥, ♠, depending on bidding

Example

When the trump rank is 4 and the trump suit is ♠ (colloquially, when the trump suit is 4♠), the trump suit is

2♠3♠5♠6♠7♠8♠9♠10♠J♠Q♠K♠A♠4♣4♦4♥4♠LJHJ

and the heart suit is

2♥3♥5♥6♥7♥8♥9♥10♥J♥Q♥K♥A♥.

Above, the cards are in strictly increasing order in their suits, except 4♣, 4♦, and 4♥ are equal. So generally, 2 is the lowest and A is the highest.

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Example

Example

When the trump rank is 4 and the trump suit is ♠ (colloquially, when the trump suit is 4♠), the trump suit is

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and the heart suit is

2♥3♥5♥6♥7♥8♥9♥10♥J♥Q♥K♥A♥.

Above, the cards are in strictly increasing order in their suits, except 4♣, 4♦, and 4♥ are equal. So generally, 2 is the lowest and A is the highest.

A reminder

When the trump suit is 4♠, the trump suit is

2♠3♠5♠6♠7♠8♠9♠10♠J♠Q♠K♠A♠4♣4♦4♥4♠LJHJ

and the heart suit is

2♥3♥5♥6♥7♥8♥9♥10♥J♥Q♥K♥A♥.

WHEN THE TRUMP SUIT IS 4♠, 4♥ IS NOT IN THE HEART SUIT!!!

It is in the trump suit consisting of spades, 4s, and jokers.

Slogan: “4♥ is a ♠.”

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└ A reminder

You will forget despite the triple exclamation point, and that's okay.

A reminder

When the trump suit is 4♠, the trump suit is
2♠3♠5♠6♠7♠8♠9♠10♠J♠Q♠K♠A♠4♣4♦4♥4♠LJHJ
and the heart suit is
2♥3♥5♥6♥7♥8♥9♥10♥J♥Q♥K♥A♥.
WHEN THE TRUMP SUIT IS 4♠, 4♥ IS NOT IN THE HEART SUIT!!!
It is in the trump suit consisting of spades, 4s, and jokers.
Slogan: "4♥ is a ♠."

Example

4♠ is trump.

- Obama plays 4♦.
- Trump plays 4♣.
- Biden plays 10♠.
- Reagan plays 5♠.

The Democrats win the trick and 15 points.

2026-06-26
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Example

Example

4♠ is trump.
• Obama plays 4♦.
• Trump plays 4♣.
• Biden plays 10♠.
• Reagan plays 5♠.
The Democrats win the trick and 15 points.

Example

- 4♠ is trump.
- Obama plays 4♦.
 - Trump plays 4♠.
 - Biden plays 10♠.
 - Reagan plays 5♠.

The Republicans win the trick and 15 points.

2026-06-26

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└ Example

Example

4♠ is trump.
• Obama plays 4♦.
• Trump plays 4♠.
• Biden plays 10♠.
• Reagan plays 5♠.
The Republicans win the trick and 15 points.

Types of plays

the “lead” plays something. . .

What is “something?”

- A single
- A pair
 - Pairs: $9\heartsuit 9\spadesuit$. HJHJ.
 - Not pairs: when $6\heartsuit$ trump, $2\clubsuit 2\spadesuit$, $6\clubsuit 6\spadesuit$, LJHJ.
- A tractor (sequences of consecutive pairs)
 - Tractors: when $6\heartsuit$ trump, $9\heartsuit 9\spadesuit 10\heartsuit 10\spadesuit$, $5\heartsuit 5\spadesuit 7\heartsuit 7\spadesuit$, $A\heartsuit A\spadesuit 6\heartsuit 6\spadesuit 6\heartsuit 6\spadesuit$ LJLJHJHJ
 - Not tractors: when $6\heartsuit$ trump, $A\clubsuit A\spadesuit 2\clubsuit 2\spadesuit$, $6\clubsuit 6\spadesuit 6\clubsuit 6\spadesuit$

In particular, *you cannot play straights.*

2026-06-26

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Types of plays

Types of plays

the “lead” plays something. . .
What is “something?”

- A single
- A pair
 - Pairs: $9\heartsuit 9\spadesuit$. HJHJ.
 - Not pairs: when $6\heartsuit$ trump, $2\clubsuit 2\spadesuit$, $6\clubsuit 6\spadesuit$, LJHJ.
- A tractor (sequences of consecutive pairs)
 - Tractors: when $6\heartsuit$ trump, $9\heartsuit 9\spadesuit 10\heartsuit 10\spadesuit$, $5\heartsuit 5\spadesuit 7\heartsuit 7\spadesuit$, $A\heartsuit A\spadesuit 6\heartsuit 6\spadesuit 6\heartsuit 6\spadesuit$ LJLJHJHJ
 - Not tractors: when $6\heartsuit$ trump, $A\clubsuit A\spadesuit 2\clubsuit 2\spadesuit$, $6\clubsuit 6\spadesuit 6\clubsuit 6\spadesuit$

In particular, you cannot play straights.

Pairs must be completely identical. Tractors can't “loop around.”

Bidding occurs while drawing. Two purposes:

- Decide host for first round
- Decide the *trump suit*

In increasing order, the possible bids are a single of the trump rank, a pair of the trump rank, a pair LJ, and a pair HJ. You keep the cards you bid.

You can't overturn your own bid, but you can reinforce a bid of a single by making it into a pair.

2026-06-26

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Bidding

Bidding

Bidding occurs while drawing. Two purposes:
• Decide host for first round
• Decide the *trump suit*
In increasing order, the possible bids are a single of the trump rank, a pair of the trump rank, a pair LJ, and a pair HJ. You keep the cards you bid.
You can't overturn your own bid, but you can reinforce a bid of a single by making it into a pair.

No trump

If a single/pair of the trump rank is bid, the suit of the winning bid is just the trump suit. But if a pair of jokers is bid, the trump suit is *no trump* (NT). This means there are *five* suits: ♣, ♦, ♥, ♠, and the trump suit consisting of the cards of the trump rank and jokers.

2026-06-26

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└ No trump

For example, if the trump rank is 6 and 6♠6♠ is the winning bid, the trump suit will be 6♠.

No trump

If a single/pair of the trump rank is bid, the suit of the winning bid is just the trump suit. But if a pair of jokers is bid, the trump suit is no trump (NT). This means there are five suits: ♣, ♦, ♥, ♠, and the trump suit consisting of the cards of the trump rank and jokers.

Example

When the trump suit is 4NT, the trump suit is

4♣4♦4♥4♠LJHJ

where 4♣ = 4♦ = 4♥ = 4♠ < LJ < HJ, and the club suit is

2♣3♣5♣6♣7♣8♣9♣10♣J♣Q♣K♣A♣

in increasing order.

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Example

Example

When the trump suit is 4NT, the trump suit is

4♣4♦4♥4♠LJHJ

where 4♣ = 4♦ = 4♥ = 4♠ < LJ < HJ, and the club suit is

2♣3♣5♣6♣7♣8♣9♣10♣J♣Q♣K♣A♣

in increasing order.

Example

Trump rank 2, first round.

- Obama bids 2♣.
- Reagan overturns with 2♠2♠.

There are no more overturns. Reagan is host with trump suit 2♠.

2026-06-26

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Example

Example

Trump rank 2, first round.

- Obama bids 2♣.
- Reagan overturns with 2♠2♠.

There are no more overturns. Reagan is host with trump suit 2♠.

First bullet: If Obama won at this point, the trump suit would be clubs
Second bullet: Reagan could not have overturned with just a single 2♠.

Example

Trump rank 4.

- Obama bids 4♣.
- Obama reinforces with 4♣4♣.
- Trump bids LJLJ.
- Obama bids HJHJ.

The trump suit is 4NT.

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Example

Second bullet: Obama drew another 4♣.

The only point of Obama's bid is to tell the table that he has HJHJ.

Example

Trump rank 4.

- Obama bids 4♣.
 - Obama reinforces with 4♣4♣.
 - Trump bids LJLJ.
 - Obama bids HJHJ.
- The trump suit is 4NT.

*the players proceed counterclockwise **matching format**. . .*

What is “matching format?”

- First priority: match suit
- Second priority: match shape

If you can't match suit, you don't need to match shape. Players always play the same number of cards.

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└ Matching format

The actual rules for matching format are rather complicated, so we instead just give a lot of examples.

Matching format

*the players proceed counterclockwise **matching format**. . .*

What is "matching format?"

- First priority: match suit
- Second priority: match shape

If you can't match suit, you don't need to match shape. Players always play the same number of cards.

Example

10♦ is trump.

- Obama plays A♣.
 - Trump's ♣: 5♣5♣K♣. He plays 5♣.
 - Biden has no ♣. He trumps it with K♦.
 - Reagan has no ♣. He trumps it with 10♣.
- Reagan's 10♣ wins 25 points for the Republicans.

2026-06-26

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Example

Example

10♦ is trump.
• Obama plays A♣.
• Trump's ♣: 5♣5♣K♣. He plays 5♣.
• Biden has no ♣. He trumps it with K♦.
• Reagan has no ♣. He trumps it with 10♣.
Reagan's 10♣ wins 25 points for the Republicans.

Example

10♦ is trump.

- Obama plays K♥.
- Trump plays 2♥.
- Biden has no ♥ and plays A♠.
- Reagan plays 5♥.

Obama wins the trick and 15 points.

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Example

Cards in different off-suits are not comparable, so Obama's K♥ beats Biden's A♠.

Example

10♦ is trump.
• Obama plays K♥.
• Trump plays 2♥.
• Biden has no ♥ and plays A♠.
• Reagan plays 5♥.
Obama wins the trick and 15 points.

Example

10♦ is trump.

- Obama plays 4♦.
- Trump plays 4♦.
- Biden has no ♦, 10s, or jokers, and plays 7♥.
- Reagan plays 2♦.

Obama wins the trick and 0 points.

2026-06-26

Tractor

Example

Example

10♦ is trump.
• Obama plays 4♦.
• Trump plays 4♦.
• Biden has no ♦, 10s, or jokers, and plays 7♥.
• Reagan plays 2♦.
Obama wins the trick and 0 points.

8♦ is trump.

- Obama plays K♥K♥.
- Trump's ♥: 2♥3♥5♥5♥9♥. He plays 5♥5♥.
- Biden's ♥: 3♥7♥7♥10♥J♥. He plays 7♥7♥.
- Reagan's ♥: 6♥A♥. He plays 6♥A♥.

Obama wins the trick and 30 points.

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Example

Second bullet: he's forced. Third bullet: he's also forced.

Example

8♦ is trump.

- Obama plays K♥K♥.
- Trump's ♥: 2♥3♥5♥5♥9♥. He plays 5♥5♥.
- Biden's ♥: 3♥7♥7♥10♥J♥. He plays 7♥7♥.
- Reagan's ♥: 6♥A♥. He plays 6♥A♥.

Obama wins the trick and 30 points.

8♦ is trump.

- Obama plays K♥K♥.
- Trump has no ♥ and trumps it with 10♦10♦.
- Biden has exactly one ♥ left: the 10♥. He plays 10♥8♠.
- Reagan is out of ♥ and plays 10♣10♠.

Trump wins the trick and 70 points.

2026-06-26

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Example

Third bullet: Biden is forced to play the 10♥. Biden’s play does not win. Reagan has pairs left, but you no longer need to match shape once you can’t match suit.

Example

8♦ is trump.

- Obama plays K♥K♥.
- Trump has no ♥ and trumps it with 10♦10♦.
- Biden has exactly one ♥ left: the 10♥. He plays 10♥8♠.
- Reagan is out of ♥ and plays 10♣10♠.

Trump wins the trick and 70 points.

8♦ is trump.

- Obama plays K♥K♥.
- Trump has no ♥ and tries to trump it with 6♦7♦.
- Biden's ♥: 10♥. He plays 10♥10♠.
- Reagan plays 2♣4♣.

Obama wins the trick and 40 points.

2026-06-26

Tractor

Example

Third bullet: Biden is forced to play 10♥here.
Fourth bullet: Reagan has pairs left, but you no longer need to match shape once you can't match suit.

Example

8♦ is trump.

- Obama plays K♥K♥.
- Trump has no ♥ and tries to trump it with 6♦7♦.
- Biden's ♥: 10♥. He plays 10♥10♠.
- Reagan plays 2♣4♣.

Obama wins the trick and 40 points.

8♦ is trump.

- Obama plays 7♥7♥9♥9♥.
- Trump's ♥: 6♥10♥K♥. He plays 6♥10♥K♥4♠.
- Biden's ♥: 2♥3♥3♥10♥K♥A♥A♥. He plays 3♥3♥A♥A♥.
- Reagan has no ♥ and plays A♦A♦8♥8♥.

Reagan wins the trick and 20 points.

2026-06-26

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Example

Fourth bullet: Reagan has pairs left, but you no longer need to match shape once you can't match suit.

Example

8♦ is trump.

- Obama plays 7♥7♥9♥9♥.
- Trump's ♥: 6♥10♥K♥. He plays 6♥10♥K♥4♠.
- Biden's ♥: 2♥3♥3♥10♥K♥A♥A♥. He plays 3♥3♥A♥A♥.
- Reagan has no ♥ and plays A♦A♦8♥8♥.

Reagan wins the trick and 20 points.

Example

8♦ is trump.

- Obama plays 2♠2♠.
- Trump plays 4♠Q♠.
- Biden plays 6♠A♠.
- Reagan plays 3♠3♠.

Reagan wins the trick and 0 points.

2026-06-26

Tractor

Example

Example

8♦ is trump.
• Obama plays 2♠2♠.
• Trump plays 4♠Q♠.
• Biden plays 6♠A♠.
• Reagan plays 3♠3♠.
Reagan wins the trick and 0 points.

Trump must be out of spade pairs.

Scoring rules

Attacker points	Name	Result
0	sweep	defenders +3
[5, 35]		defenders +2
[40, 75]		defenders +1
[80, 115]	stalemate	no change
[120, 155]		attackers +1
[160, 195]		attackers +2
[200, ∞)	attacker sweep	attackers +3

Stalemate and above is considered a win for the attackers, in which case the attacking team becomes the new host.

2026-06-26 Tractor

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[200, ∞)	attacker sweep	attackers +3

Stalemate and above is considered a win for the attackers, in which case the attacking team becomes the new host.

Throwing

Throwing allows you to play multiple things at the same time, as long as nothing played can be beaten within the suit.

After a throw is played, players affirm in counterclockwise order they can't defeat any component. If the throw's invalid, the component that can be defeated is played. If multiple components can be defeated, the first player (in counterclockwise order) which can defeat any component chooses which component they can defeat is played.

In order to trump or re-trump a throw, you need to strictly beat every component.

2026-06-26

Tractor

└ Throwing

This choice option is not implemented online.

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Throwing allows you to play multiple things at the same time, as long as nothing played can be beaten within the suit.

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In order to trump or re-trump a throw, you need to strictly beat every component.

Example

4♥ is trump.

- Obama throws A♠Q♠Q♠. Everyone affirms this throw is valid.
- Trump plays 10♠2♥2♥.
- Biden plays 5♠6♠6♠.
- Reagan plays 3♠6♦7♦.

Obama wins the trick and 15 points.

2026-06-26

Tractor

Example

First bullet: Obama is holding a K♠. if he played AKK, then there's no need to check.

Second bullet: This doesn't win, since he didn't beat every component

Third bullet: The original play draws pairs, as usual.

The point is that throwing makes your stuff harder to trump.

Example

4♥ is trump.
• Obama throws A♠Q♠Q♠. Everyone affirms this throw is valid.
• Trump plays 10♠2♥2♥.
• Biden plays 5♠6♠6♠.
• Reagan plays 3♠6♦7♦.
Obama wins the trick and 15 points.

Example

4♥ is trump.

- Obama throws A♠9♠9♠10♠10♠. Trump says the throw is invalid, so only the 9♠9♠10♠10♠ goes through. Obama takes back the A♠.
- Trump plays Q♠Q♠K♠K♠.
- Biden plays 2♠2♠5♠8♦.
- Reagan plays 5♠6♠6♠7♠.

Trump wins the trick and 50 points.

2026-06-26

Tractor

Example

Example

4♥ is trump.

- Obama throws A♠9♠9♠10♠10♠. Trump says the throw is invalid, so only the 9♠9♠10♠10♠ goes through. Obama takes back the A♠.
- Trump plays Q♠Q♠K♠K♠.
- Biden plays 2♠2♠5♠8♦.
- Reagan plays 5♠6♠6♠7♠.

Trump wins the trick and 50 points.

Example

4♥ is trump.

- Obama throws A♠K♠. Assume an A♠ was already played, so this throw is valid.
- Trump plays 10♥K♥.
- Biden plays K♥HJ.
- Reagan plays 6♦7♦.

Biden wins the trick and 40 points.

2026-06-26

Tractor

Example

Second bullet: Trump trumped it too low.
Third bullet: Biden's K♥HJ is unbeatable.

Example

4♥ is trump.
• Obama throws A♠K♠. Assume an A♠ was already played, so this throw is valid.
• Trump plays 10♥K♥.
• Biden plays K♥HJ.
• Reagan plays 6♦7♦.
Biden wins the trick and 40 points.

After everyone draws 25 cards, the host picks up the 8 remaining cards (the “kitty”) and replaces it with their 8 worst ones.

Whoever wins the last trick wins all the points in the kitty. Additionally, the points are multiplied by 2^n , where n is the size of the largest component of the last trick.

- With a single, kitty points are $\times 2$ 'd.
- With a pair, kitty points are $\times 4$ 'd.
- With a tractor, kitty points are $\times 16$ 'd.

2026-06-26

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└ Kitty multiplier

Kitty multiplier

After everyone draws 25 cards, the host picks up the 8 remaining cards (the “kitty”) and replaces it with their 8 worst ones.

Whoever wins the last trick wins all the points in the kitty. Additionally, the points are multiplied by 2^n , where n is the size of the largest component of the last trick.

- With a single, kitty points are $\times 2$ 'd.
- With a pair, kitty points are $\times 4$ 'd.
- With a tractor, kitty points are $\times 16$ 'd.

Imagine the host puts 80 points in the kitty. Then there are only 120 points left for the attackers to win. What the hell? Imagine the host puts 80 points in the kitty. Then there are only 120 points left for the attackers to win. What the hell?

“cracking the kitty.”

So you generally don't want to put points in the kitty, unless your trump is very strong.

Finding friends

- *Zhao peng you* (找朋友, literally “finding friends”), also called “zpy” or “ff:” a variant allowing the game to be played with an odd number of players
- With n players, landlord has $f := \lfloor \frac{n}{2} \rfloor - 1$ friends
- Make f calls of the form “ i th card c played is my teammate” (c can’t be trump)
 - Examples: first A♣ or second A♠
- Host and friends can join team multiple times
- Small team bonus: if this happens and host wins, their team goes up an extra rank
- Despite this, small teams suck
- 7p7d zpy is the greatest form of Tractor

2026-06-26

Tractor

└ Finding friends

1. You usually want to call aces and play like a king or something to transfer control.
2. The teams are different each round, you just want to advance ranks personally.
3. Teams are unusually small if self-join. You should try hard to not be your own friend.

Finding friends

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Example

2NT is trump. 5p5d zpy. Host called 3rd A♠. First play.

- Obama throws 3♦3♦4♦4♦5♦5♦6♦6♦7♦7♦8♦8♦A♦. Biden says the throw fails.
- Trump plays 3♦4♦4♦5♦7♦8♦9♦9♦10♦J♦Q♦A♦.
- Biden plays 8♦8♦9♦9♦10♦10♦J♦J♦Q♦Q♦K♦K♦.
- Reagan plays some 12 cards.
- Bush plays some 12 cards.

Biden wins the trick.

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Tractor

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SKISSY SQRT!

The above *actually happened*. The host was forced to self-friend and got swept.

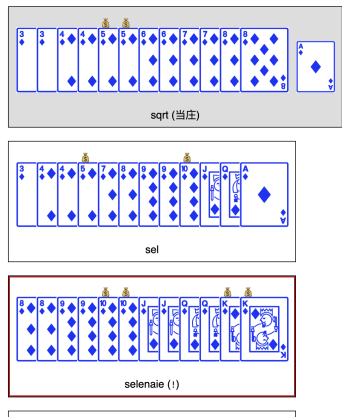
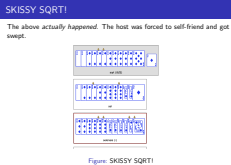


Figure: SKISSY SQRT!

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└ SKISSY SQRT!



Single J rule

If the defenders are rank J and the attackers win the last trick with a single J, the defenders go back to rank 2. Any rank change from that round still occurs after the defenders go back to rank 2.

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Tractor

└ Single J rule

Lots of people forget this rule.

Single J rule

If the defenders are rank J and the attackers win the last trick with a single J, the defenders go back to rank 2. Any rank change from that round still occurs after the defenders go back to rank 2.

- Play offsuit aces, high pairs, then low pairs. If you have nothing, play low trump to try and transfer control to your teammate.
- Try to get rid of offsuits.
- Play suits your teammate is out of. Don't play suits your opponents are out of.
- Try not to break up pairs.
- Don't throw only singles in suits your opponents are out of.
- If opponents play points/aces in offsuits, they're likely almost out.

2026-06-26

Tractor

Basic strategy

Keep track of the suits people are out of.

In general, you don't want to break up pairs, however, it's sometimes okay to break up pairs of points to feed. This heavily depends on the situation, though. For example, since king pairs, my king Daniel Ge.

If you have a pair that's not 5, T, or K, try not to break it up. There's no point, literally and figuratively. The strategy is different in 4d, but whatever.

Basic strategy

- Play offsuit aces, high pairs, then low pairs. If you have nothing, play low trump to try and transfer control to your teammate.
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- On <https://robertying.com/shengji/>, parts of this presentation are adapted from <https://robertying.com/shengji/rules.html>
- Forces you to follow the rules
- Has “help” button telling you what you’re allowed to play
- Has “BEEP” button to tell others to hurry up
- Allows for 1v1s via splitscreen

An example game

<https://robertying.com/shengji/>